



Airtel Digital TV DTH system

However, the basic Tata Sky connection runs on MPEG-2 and doesn't provide all the channels. The limited number of channels is its biggest drawback. The showcase or movie channels offered are not too good.

Big TV. It runs on MPEG-4 and offers quite a good number of channels and interactive applications. A mini guide lets you know what's showing on your other favourite channel while watching Live TV. An interactive mosaic window displays twelve

Live TV channels from one category per screen. This screen where you can watch a preview of sets of 12 channels makes navigation easier. Also, you can set up a personal programme guide of the channels you watch the most.

But the EPG is very confusing. As it is symbol-oriented, you will be spending a lot of time to find the functionality. Even the remote control keys are confusing with just symbols being depicted.

Airtel Digital TV. It also runs on MPEG-4. It uses 20 per cent larger dish antenna for better performance during rain. Other important features include a universal remote for both set-top box and TV, large set-top box memory, content such as World Space radio and interactive applications (book cinema tickets, browse and book travel packages, and shop on TV for your favourite brands).

To make its call centres more customer-friendly, Airtel is offering 24x7 customer support in eight languages, including Bengali.

How to buy?

First and foremost, check with your friends and other us-

Checklist

1. Quality of the customer service and toll-free helpline for complaints and inquiries
2. Channel packaging (should include your favourite channels) and cost
3. Software quality of the set-top box
4. Channel surfing time
5. User-friendliness of the EPG
6. User-friendliness of the remote
7. Language options (if you are not comfortable with English)
8. Recharge modes (Internet, mobile phone, voucher and auto-debit)
9. Interactive applications (if you want more than channel surfing)
10. Hidden costs (maintenance, installation and other charges)

ers about the quality of the customer service provided by the broadcaster. You'll need to contact customer care at least once a month, especially if you wish to change your channels package often. So a toll-free helpline for your complaints and inquiries would be good. Otherwise, it will be an added cost for you. And if the customer service is not good, you might end up missing your favourite programmes.

Now look for the channel packaging done by the broadcaster. Consider the channels that you wish to watch and then compare the package cost. Beware of packaging plays: A broadcaster might be offering you all the channels free for a certain period, but once the free period is over you might end up paying more for the same number of channels. If your most favourite channels lie in different packages, you'll end up paying for all other channels that you never ever watch.

Check out the software quality of the set-top box. The set-top box works with a software running inside it. And a buggy software will result in crashes too often. For sure, you would not like your set-top box getting rebooted every half an hour or during the climax of a movie.

Channel surfing should be quite fast. If changing channels takes long



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